

This is a sample PDF for the FAQ generator.

The ***Mahābhārata*** (/məˌhɑːˈbɑːrətə, ˌmɑːhə/ *mə-HAH-BAR-ə-tə*, *MAH-hə*-;<sup>[1][2][3][4]</sup>  
**Sanskrit:** महाभारतम्, **IAST:** *Mahābhāratam*, pronounced [məhaːˈbʱaːrət̪əm]) is a **smṛiti** text (also described as a **Sanskrit epic**) from **ancient India**, one of the two important epics of **Hinduism** known as the *Itihasas*, the other being the *Ramayana*.<sup>[5]</sup> It narrates the events and aftermath of the **Kurukshetra War**, a **war of succession** between two groups of princely cousins, the **Kauravas** and the **Pāṇḍavas**. It contains **philosophical** and **devotional** material, such as a discussion of the four "goals of life" or *puruṣārtha* (12.161). Among the principal works and stories in the *Mahābhārata* are the **Bhagavad Gita**, the story of **Damayanti**, the story of **Shakuntala**, the story of **Pururava** and **Urvashi**, the story of **Savitri and Satyavan**, the story of **Kacha** and **Devayani**, the story of **Rishyasringa** and an **abbreviated version of the *Rāmāyaṇa***, often considered as works in their own right.